

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣ J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ 7

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣ K

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ 10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10
♥ 10 9 6 4
♦ 10 9 5
♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4



♠ 9 8

♥ A 7 3 2

♦ Q J 4

♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points NORTH should open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

NORTH adds: her 16 plus SOUTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

♠ 9 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4 3

♣ 7 4 2

EAST has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal EAST will open 1♠.

WEST has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

EAST adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

3♠

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♦Q

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 7 2

♥ A 6

♦ A 10 8

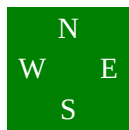
♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ K 9 5 2

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ A K



♠ Q J 9 3

♥ 7 4

♦ 9 4 2

♣ J 10 8 3

♠ K 5

♥ Q J 10 8 3

♦ K Q J

♣ 9 6 2

SOUTH has a minimum 1♥ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

NORTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of SOUTH's ♥s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids 4♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠7

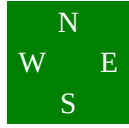
Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 7 4		♠ K Q 9 2
♥ A K 5		♥ Q J
♦ A K 3		♦ Q 7 6 4
♣ 9		♣ J 8 4

♠ 5		
♥ 10 8 4		
♦ J 10 9 5		
♣ 10 7 6 5 3		



WEST has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♠.

EAST has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3♠.

WEST now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by West			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

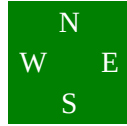
♠ Q
♥ K J 8 4
♦ Q J 10 6 2
♣ Q 7 2

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4



♠ K 8
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 10 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 10

NORTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

SOUTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So South should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.